

COMMUNITY WARNING: KRATOM PRODUCTS

These products look like snacks, energy drinks, or herbal supplements — but kratom can affect the brain the same way strong prescription pain medicine does. These items are being sold in gas stations and vape shops where teens shop every day.



Many teens don't realize kratom is a mind-altering substance. The packaging is colorful, trendy, and often designed to blend in with everyday drinks and gummies.

WHAT IS KRATOM?

Kratom comes from the leaves of a Southeast Asian tree. It can create stimulant effects at low doses, and strong painkiller-like effects at higher doses — including drowsiness, confusion, and dependence.

WHY IT CONCERNS PARENTS

- Packaging looks harmless — bright bags, candy colors, and fruit flavors.
- Products vary in strength — labels may not match what's inside.
- Kratom can lead to strong dependence and difficult withdrawal.



WHAT TEENS ARE BUYING



SIGNS YOUR TEEN MAY BE USING KRATOM

- Very small pupils.
- Sudden fatigue or trouble staying awake.
- Sweating, shaking, irritability.
- Hidden packets labeled 'kratom,' 'maeng da,' or brightly colored drinks.

WHAT YOU CAN DO

- Check local stores — kratom is often placed near candy, vapes, or energy drinks.

- Inspect backpacks, glove compartments, drawers, and trash bins.
- Have a calm conversation: "These look harmless, but they can affect your brain like strong pain medicine. I want you safe."

Emergency: Trouble staying awake or slowed breathing → Call **911**.

Poison Control: **1-800-222-1222**

SCAN TO LEARN MORE ABOUT KRATOM



MothersAgainstHerbalAbuse.org/Kratom